

Publishing Policy

Institute of Minecraft Studies Publishing Department

I Submission

1. § In order to speed up editing, writings should be formatted in accordance with the [style guide](#).
2. § If the work has multiple authors or contributors, it must contain contributorship statements, explaining how each of them contributed.
3. § Any (raw) data (including datasets, interview materials, surveys, code, scripts) is expected to be made available to the readership, where ethically, legally, and practically possible. Otherwise, a clear explanation must be given.
4. § Authors must explicitly declare their AI usage and relevant conflicts of interest (or lacks thereof).
5. § Authors must license their work under [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#).
6. § Journal staff collect articles to publish from the #draft-manuscripts channel in the [IMS Discord server](#). Optionally, authors can ping the Journal coordinator in the [Department's Discord server](#).
7. § Authors with works intended for the IMS Substack must ping the Press coordinator with the work attached in the #manuscript-submissions channel in the [Department's Discord server](#).
8. § Columnists and reporters may write on any topic of their choosing. Furthermore, the Press coordinator may assign certain topics to columnists or reporters to write about.

9. § Before proceeding, the author is asked for consent. Authors may revoke their consent anytime before publishing without giving a reason.

10. § If an author wishes to remain anonymous, they may reach out to the relevant coordinator, the editor-in-chief, or an IMS admin, who accommodates the request.

11. § An editor or a group of editors volunteers or is assigned by the relevant coordinator to the work, based on its length and the required manpower.

12. § A submission is rejected by the editor if

- (1) it is low quality,
- (2) it is outside of the scope of the Department,
- (3) it contains unethical content or used unethical practices, or
- (4) it is uninteresting, unoriginal, or otherwise does not add value to the library of published work of the IMS.

13. § Submissions may not be rejected solely for having inconclusive findings or findings that are not statistically significant. Works may not be rejected for reasons outside of §12.

II Peer review

14. § If the work passed our basic checks, an in-depth peer review phase follows. Opinion pieces, columns, and news articles are generally not peer reviewed.

15. § The editor requests well-respected IMS members for peer review. A list of some IMS members and their area of expertise is available. When selecting reviewers, the following aspects should be taken into consideration: expertise, reputation, specific recommendations, and previous experience.

16. § For simpler works, one reviewer performs this task; for larger, more complex works, multiple reviewers do so. Reviewers must explicitly declare their AI usage and relevant conflicts of interest (or lacks thereof). This review

process is not "blind", i.e., reviewers are aware of who the author is and vice versa (unless anonymity was requested).

17. § The purpose of peer review is to strengthen the article. The reviewer provides thorough, accurate, objective, constructive, clear, and justifiable feedback within the agreed time frame, which the author is expected to implement. Appendix C contains the assessment criteria for reviewing.

18. § Confidential comments to the editor are welcome. The reviewer may suggest rejection, which is decided by the editor.

III Editing

19. § After peer review, an in-depth editing phase follows. The editor provides thorough, accurate, objective, constructive, clear, and justifiable feedback in a timely manner, which the author is expected to implement. The editor ensures the work follows the [style guide](#). This editing process is similarly not blind.

IV Publishing

20. § The work may only be published if the author agrees with its final form.

21. § The journal article is published once all problems have been addressed; in some cases this may result in it being published in a later issue. The Journal coordinator compiles the works, checks that no rejection reason applies, and publishes the issue.	22. § The work is only published to the Substack if it meets the expected standards of publication of the IMS, once all problems have been addressed. The Press coordinator reviews the work and publishes it if no rejection reason applies.
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V Corrections, retractions

23. § Errors and feedback should be directed at the relevant coordinator.

24. § If a mistake is discovered after a journal article's publication, the Journal coordinator publishes a revised edition of that issue with the mistake fixed and an erratum in the next issue detailing the mistake. Errata are not issued for minor mistakes that any attentive reader can easily figure out on their own (e.g., typos).

25. § If a mistake is discovered after a Substack article's publication, the Press coordinator fixes the error in the article. Changes that meaningfully modify the article are noted at the end of the article with timestamps.

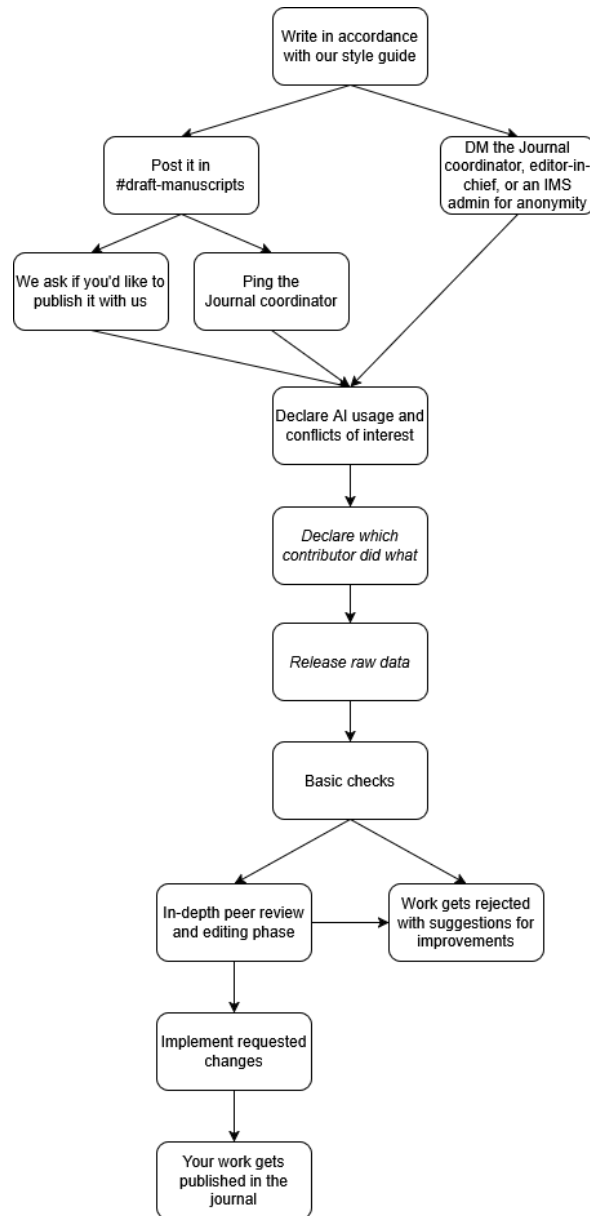
26. § If a major problem is discovered after publication (such as major errors, irregularities, misrepresentation, unethical research practices, undisclosed COI), or staff no longer feel confident in the article's findings, the Department retracts the article.

27. § A revised edition of the retracted journal article's issue is published with the article removed with an explanation, and a retraction notice is published in the next issue detailing the problem.

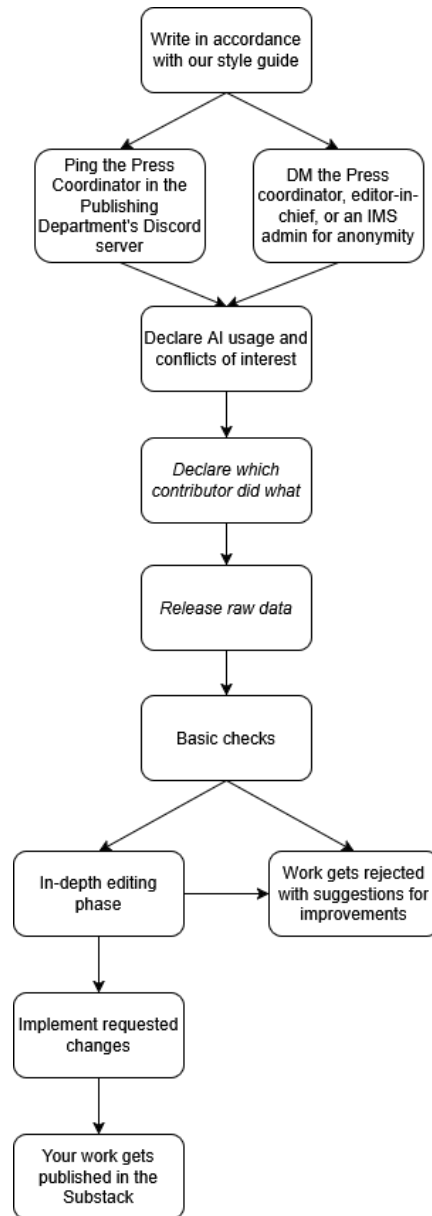
28. § A retracted Substack article is updated so that its retracted status is clearly indicated. The detailed reasoning for the retraction is also made available to the readership.

29. § Retractions are investigated as a complaint of misconduct (if the retraction did not happen due to an investigation). The primary purpose of this investigation is to prevent similar problems in the future.

A Journal publishing workflow



B Substack publishing workflow



C Peer review assessment criteria

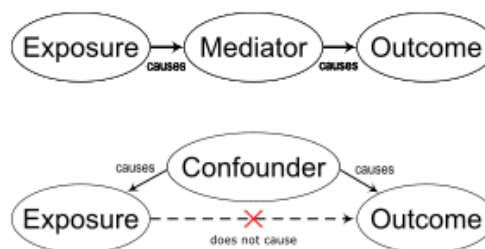
Please ignore criteria that are irrelevant.

I. Accuracy

- Are methods and results described in sufficient detail and transparent to enable reproducing the results?
- Are the methods, sample sizes, outcome measures, and data analysis valid and adequate to answer the research question?
- Is (selection) bias addressed?
- Are the data reported accurate (do the numbers add up?)
- Is anything incorrectly stated?
- Are the results credible? Is the evidence sufficient?
- Do the references support the statements being made?
- Are any references out of date or obsolete?
- Will the article add to existing knowledge?

II. Balance

- Are conclusions adequately supported by the data?
- Is anything important missing or cherry-picked?
- Are any study limitations (e.g., in interpreting the results) clearly discussed? Are alternative interpretations of the findings considered?
 - alternative hypotheses
 - confounding factors
 - shortcomings



III. Accessibility

- Is the language clear and unambiguous?
- Is the title clear, informative, representative of the content and breadth of the study, not misleading, and capturing the importance of the study and the attention of the reader?
- Does the introduction summarize the relevant and up-to-date background?
- Is the question being addressed defined?
- Are figures fully described?
- Are any diagrams misleading or incomplete?
- Does the abstract effectively summarize the work with no inconsistencies?

Please indicate any particular part of the manuscript, data, or analyses that you feel is outside the scope of your expertise, or that you were unable to assess fully.

Does the work have flaws that should prohibit its publication? If so, please provide details.

Please list additional experiments or data that could help strengthen the work in a revision.